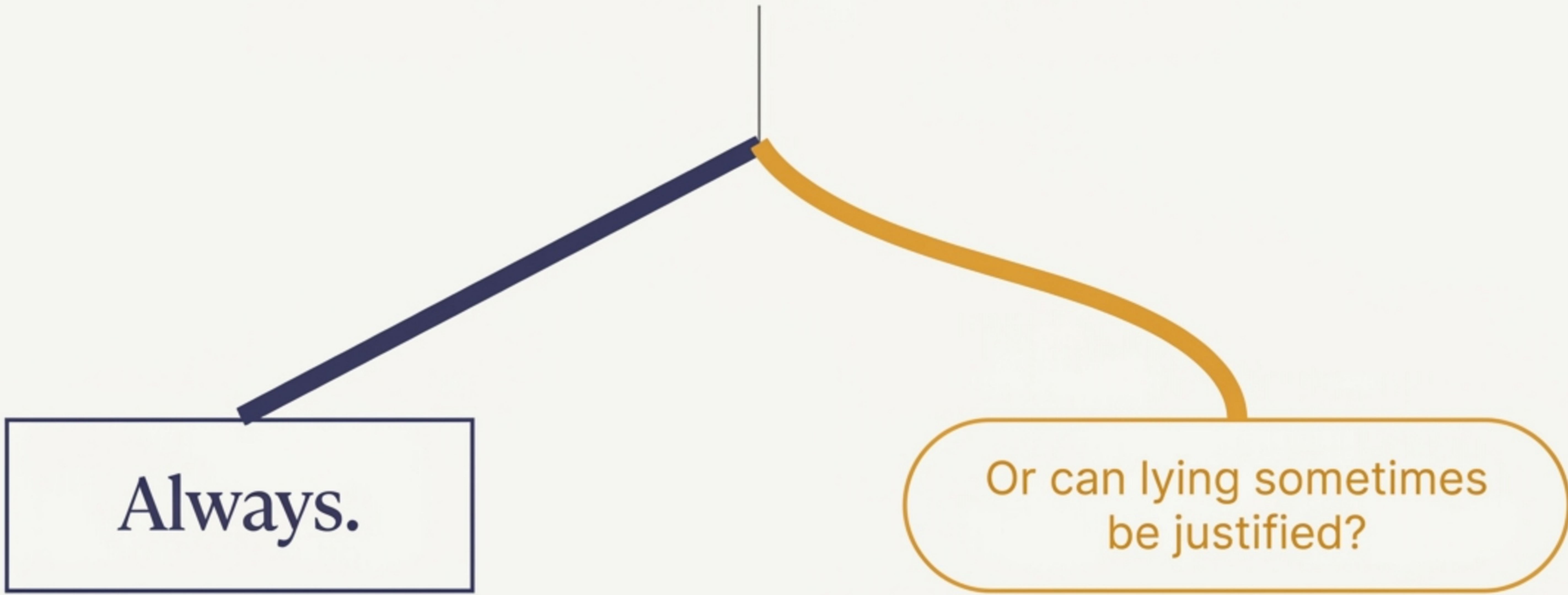


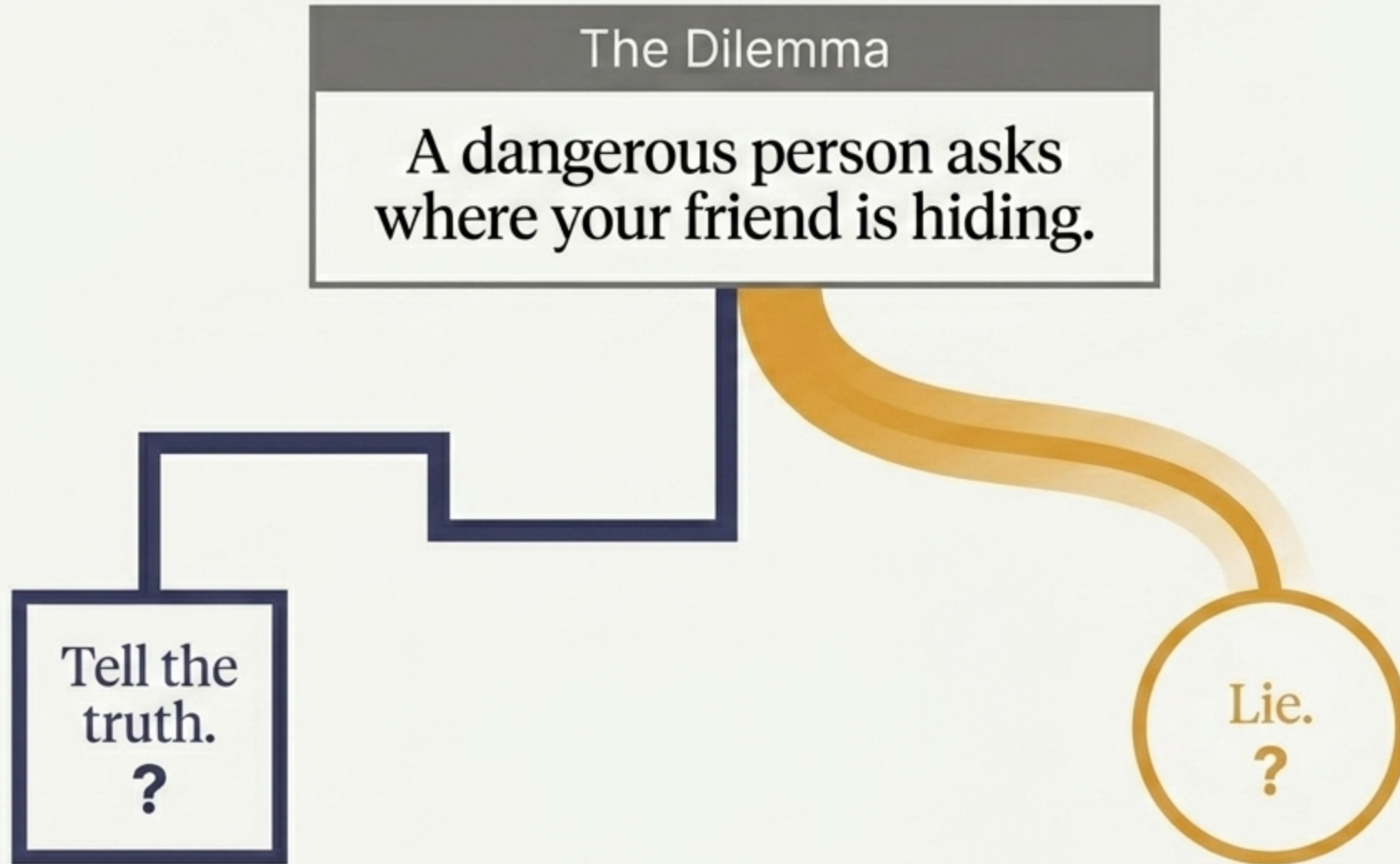
Truth and Falsehood

Two famous philosophers gave very different answers.

Is telling the truth always the right thing to do?



The knock at the door forces an impossible choice



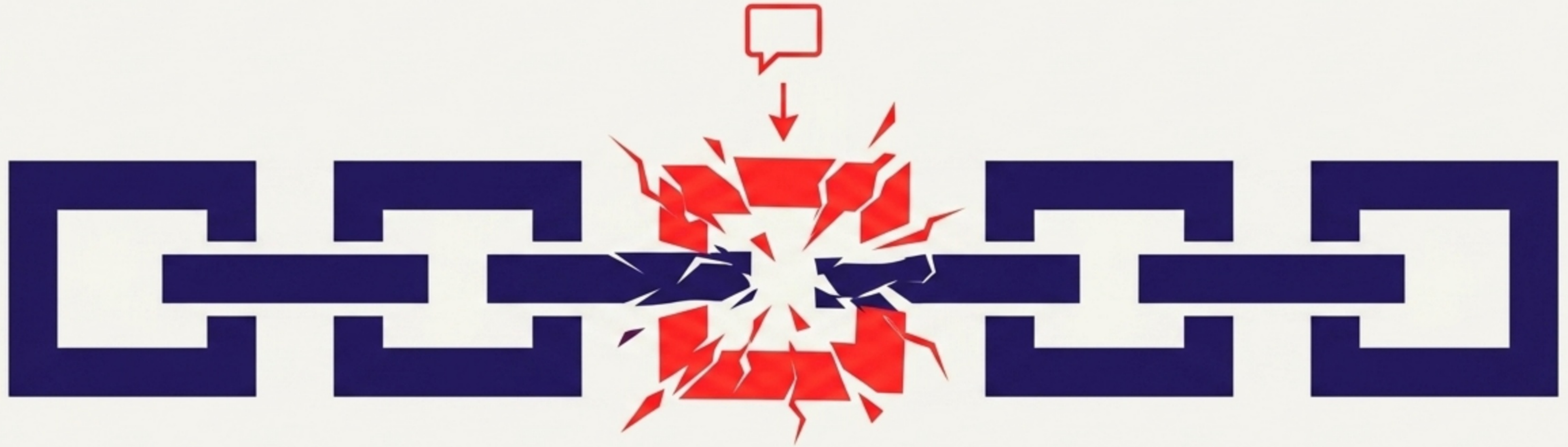
Immanuel Kant views truth as an unbending absolute

Morality should be based on duty, principles, and honesty.



Lying is always wrong... no matter the situation.

A single lie fractures the foundation of society



Even then, Kant says you should not lie. Why? Because once lying becomes acceptable, trust in society breaks down.

John Stuart Mill measures morality by its consequences

“Actions should be judged by their consequences.”



“The goal of morality is simple: Create the greatest happiness for the greatest number of people.”

A lie becomes moral when it protects human life

$[\text{Harm of a Lie}] < [\text{Value of a Life Saved}] = \text{Moral Good.}$



Then lying can be morally acceptable.

The Anatomy of a Moral Choice

Immanuel Kant (Deontology)	John Stuart Mill (Utilitarianism)
Duty & Principles	Outcomes & Happiness
Uphold the moral rule	Create the greatest good for the greatest number
Never Justified (Absolute)	Sometimes Justified (Situational)
Did you follow the rule?	Did your action produce good results?

Two internal questions govern these worldviews



**Did you follow
the moral rule?**



**Did your action
produce good
results?**

One philosophy focuses on duty and principles.
The other focuses on outcomes and human happiness.

Welcome to the timeless debate

Should truth always
be absolute?

Or should morality depend
on the situation?